

ABRSM Terms & Signs

Grades 1–3 · Questions, correct answers, and notation graphics

Compiled from the three supplied Terms & Signs PPSX presentations, with additional vocabulary and sign meanings from the attached official ABRSM terms/signs PDF and DOCX. Equivalent entries are kept within their grade section without unnecessary duplication.

Grade 1

34 questions from the Grade 1 PPSX bank, plus 6 additional official terms/signs.

1. Accelerando means:

Answer: Gradually getting quicker

2. Adagio means:

Answer: Slow

3. Allegretto means:

Answer: Fairly quick—but not as quick as allegro

4. Allegro means:

Answer: Quick

5. Andante means:

Answer: At a walking pace

6. Cantabile means:

Answer: In a singing style

7. Crescendo means:

Answer: Gradually getting louder

8. Da capo means:

Answer: Repeat from the beginning

9. Dal segno means:

Answer: Repeat from the sign

10. Decrescendo means:

Answer: Gradually getting quieter

11. Diminuendo means:

Answer: Gradually getting quieter

12. Fine means:

Answer: The end

13. f (forte) means:

Answer: Loud

14. ff (fortissimo) means:

Answer: Very loud

15. Legato means:

Answer: Smoothly

16. Lento means:

Answer: Slow

17. Mezzo means:

Answer: Half

18. Maestoso means:

Answer: Majestic

19. **mf (mezzo forte) means:**

Answer: Moderately loud

20. **mp (mezzo piano) means:**

Answer: Moderately quiet

21. **Moderato means:**

Answer: Moderately

22. **p (piano) means:**

Answer: Quiet

23. **pp (pianissimo) means:**

Answer: Very quiet

24. **Poco means:**

Answer: A little

25. **Rallentando (or rall.) means:**

Answer: Gradually getting slower

26. **Ritardando (or rit.) means:**

Answer: Gradually getting slower

27. **Ritenuto (or rit.) means:**

Answer: Held back

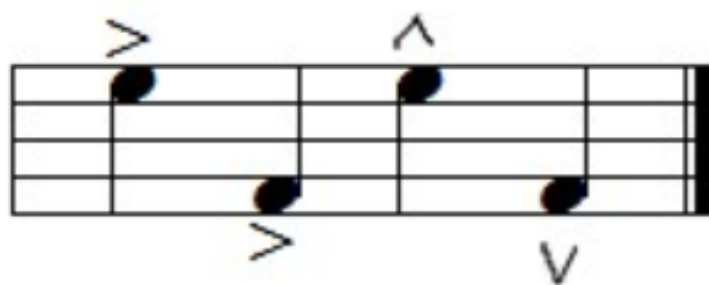
28. **Staccato (or stacc.) means:**

Answer: Detached

29. **Tempo means:**

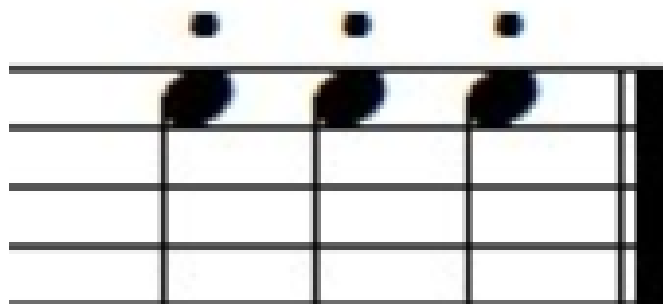
Answer: Speed/time

30. **These signs above and below the notes are:**



Answer: Accents

31. The dots above the notes are:



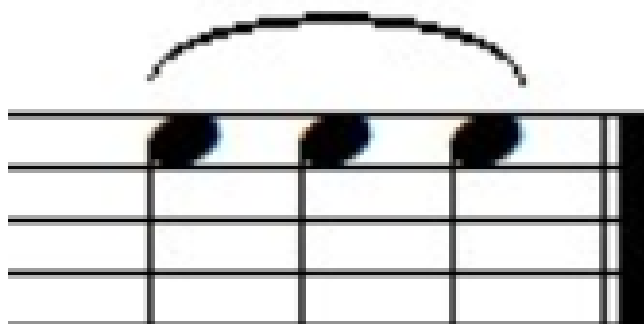
Answer: Staccato marks

32. The sign above the last note means:



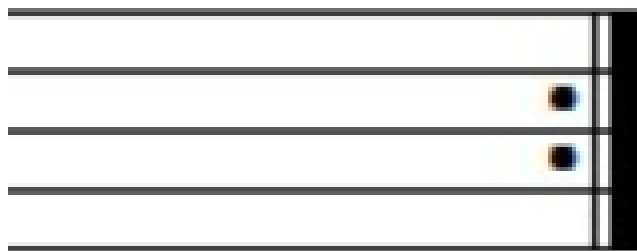
Answer: A pause

33. The sign above these notes means:



Answer: Tie

34. The two dots at the stave end mean:



Answer: Repeat last section

Additional official terms and signs

35. A tempo means:

Answer: Return to the former speed ('in time')

36. Allegro moderato means:

Answer: Moderately quick

37. Da capo al fine (D.C. al fine) means:

Answer: From the beginning until 'fine'

38. MM. crotchet = 80 means:

Answer: Maelzel's metronome, 80 beats per minute

39. Pause or fermata means:

Answer: Hold for longer than written

40. Ottava sign (8va) means:

Answer: Play one octave higher or lower than written

Sources for Grade 1: Terms+&+Signs+Grade+1.ppsx and the attached official ABRSM terms/signs materials.

Grade 2

33 questions from the Grade 2 PPSX bank, plus 7 additional official terms/signs.

1. a means:

Answer: In the style of

2. a, alla means:

Answer: In the manner of

3. Allargando means:

Answer: Broadening

4. Andantino means:

Answer: Slightly faster than andante

5. Assai means:

Answer: Very

6. Con, col means:

Answer: With

7. Dolce means:

Answer: Sweet

8. e, ed means:

Answer: And

9. Espressivo means:

Answer: Expressive

10. fp (forte-piano) means:

Answer: Loud then immediately quiet

11. Giocoso means:

Answer: Playful

12. Grave means:

Answer: Very slow, solemn

13. Grazioso means:

Answer: Graceful

14. Larghetto means:

Answer: Rather slow (but not as slow as largo)

15. Largo means:

Answer: Slow

16. Ma means:

Answer: But

17. Maestoso means:

Answer: Majestic

18. Meno means:

Answer: Less

19. Molto means:

Answer: Much

20. Mosso, moto means:

Answer: Movement

21. Non means:

Answer: Not

22. Piu means:

Answer: More

23. Presto means:

Answer: Fast

24. Senza means:

Answer: Without

25. sf, sfz (sforzando) means:

Answer: Forced, accented

26. Simile (or sim.) means:

Answer: In the same way

27. Sostenuto means:

Answer: Sustained

28. Tenuto means:

Answer: Held

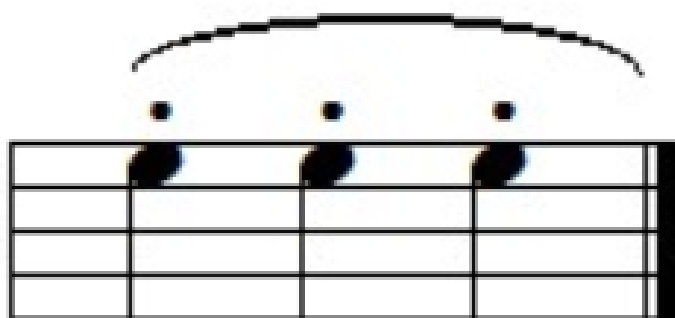
29. Troppo means:

Answer: Too much

30. Vivace, vivo means:

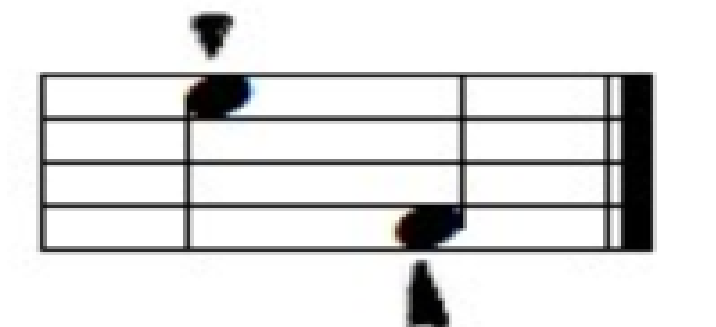
Answer: Lively, quick

31. Dots inside the slur mark mean:



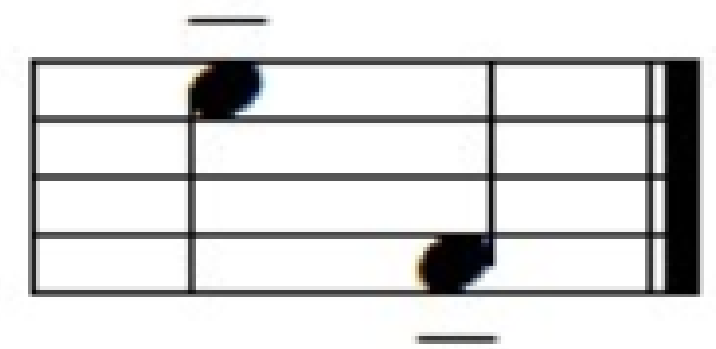
Answer: Semi-staccato

32. These wedge shapes above and below the notes mean:



Answer: Staccatissimo (super-staccato)

33. The lines above and below these notes mean:



Answer: Tenuto (held with slight pressure)

Additional official terms and signs

34. **Con moto** means:

Answer: With movement

35. **Non troppo** means:

Answer: Not too much

36. **Piu mosso** means:

Answer: More speed (faster)

37. **Accent sign** means:

Answer: Play strongly

38. **Mezzo-staccato** means:

Answer: Moderately short and detached

39. **Marcato sign** means:

Answer: A strong accent

40. **Staccatissimo** means:

Answer: Extremely short and detached

Sources for Grade 2: Terms+&+Signs+Grade+2.ppsx and the attached official ABRSM terms/signs materials.

Grade 3

39 questions from the Grade 3 PPSX bank, plus 5 additional official terms/signs.

1. adagietto means:

Answer: Rather slow

2. ad libitum, ad lib. means:

Answer: Play freely

3. Agitato means:

Answer: Agitated

4. Alla breve means:

Answer: With a minim beat

5. Amore means:

Answer: Love

6. Anima means:

Answer: Soul, spirit

7. Animato means:

Answer: Animated, lively

8. Ben means:

Answer: Well

9. Brio means:

Answer: Vigour

10. Comodo means:

Answer: Convenient

11. Deciso means:

Answer: With determination

12. Delicato means:

Answer: Delicate

13. Energico means:

Answer: Energetic

14. Forza means:

Answer: Force

15. Largamente means:

Answer: Broadly

16. Leggiero means:

Answer: Light, nimble

17. Marcato, marc. means:

Answer: Emphatic, accented

18. Marziale means:

Answer: In a military style

- 19. Mesto means:**
Answer: Sad
- 20. Pesante means:**
Answer: Heavy
- 21. Prima, primo means:**
Answer: First
- 22. Risoluto means:**
Answer: With determination
- 23. Ritmico means:**
Answer: Rhythmically
- 24. Rubato, tempo rubato means:**
Answer: With some freedom of time
- 25. Scherzando, scherzoso means:**
Answer: Playful, joking
- 26. Seconda, secondo means:**
Answer: Second
- 27. Semplice means:**
Answer: Simple, plain
- 28. Sempre means:**
Answer: Always
- 29. Stringendo means:**
Answer: Gradually getting faster
- 30. Subito means:**
Answer: Suddenly
- 31. Tanto means:**
Answer: So much
- 32. Tranquillo means:**
Answer: Calm
- 33. Triste, tristamente means:**
Answer: Sad, sorrowful
- 34. Volta means:**
Answer: Time

35. What is the meaning of the two dots at the end of the stave?



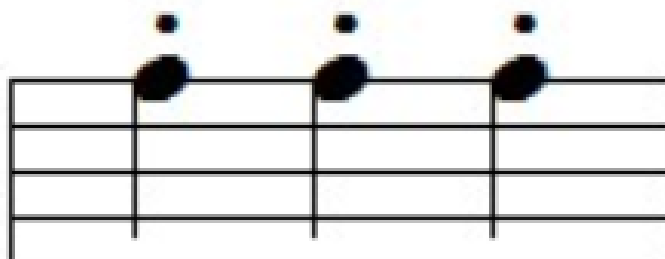
Answer: Repeat previous section

36. What does the line above the notes mean?



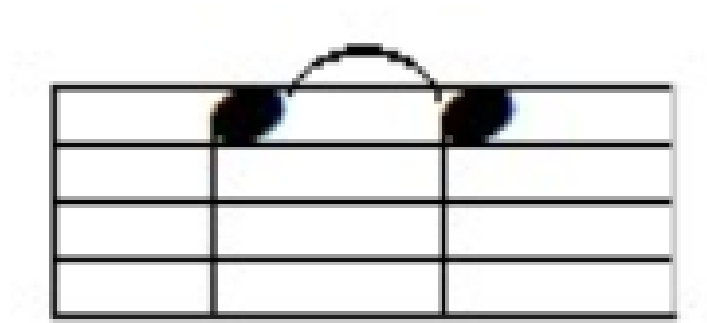
Answer: The slur

37. What is the meaning of the dots above these notes?



Answer: Staccato marks

38. What is the name of the line joining these two notes?



Answer: Tie

39. What does a crotchet = 96 mean?



Answer: 96 crotchet beats per minute

Additional official terms and signs

40. **Amoroso** means:

Answer: Loving

41. **Ben marcato** means:

Answer: Well marked

42. **Con anima** means:

Answer: With feeling, with spirit

43. **Con brio** means:

Answer: With vigour

44. **Con forza** means:

Answer: With force

Sources for Grade 3: Terms&+Signs+Grade+3.ppsx and the attached official ABRSM terms/signs materials.